

Sara Assefa

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Senior SQL Server DBA/Developer with over 7 years of experience managing and optimizing large databases in both on-premises and cloud (Azure) environments. Skilled in performance tuning, high availability, disaster recovery, and database security, with solid knowledge of HIPAA compliance. Proficient in PowerShell and Python automation, ETL pipeline development (SSIS, ADF), and full-stack collaboration using .NET, Java, and modern JavaScript frameworks such as React and Vue. Experienced with PostgreSQL and Oracle, with a strong focus on proactive system monitoring, process automation, and ensuring high database reliability, performance, and dependable on-call support.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Database Platforms:** Microsoft SQL Server (2008–2022), Azure SQL Database, Azure SQL Managed Instance, Oracle, PostgreSQL, MySQL.
- **Operating Systems:** Windows Server, Linux.
- **Performance Tuning & Optimization:** Query optimization, Execution plans, Indexing & partitioning strategy, Database tuning, Performance metrics, Maintenance tasks, Profiler & Dynamic Management Views (DMVs), Database Tuning Advisor (DTA), IDERA, Red Gate, SQL Profiler, Azure Monitor.
- **High Availability & Disaster Recovery:** Always On Availability Groups, Clustering, Log Shipping, Replication, Mirroring, Backup & Restore Strategies (Full, Differential, Transaction Log), Standby configurations, Disaster Recovery (DR) planning, Azure Backup/DR, Change Data Capture (CDC), Change Tracking, Failover Clustering.
- **Backup, Recovery & Migration:** Full, Differential, Transaction log backups, Disaster recovery planning, Large-scale data migrations & upgrades, Backup automation, Restore strategies, CDC, Change Tracking.
- **Security & Compliance:** Database security policies, Authentication & Authorization, Encryption, Roles & Permissions, RBAC (Azure Active Directory), Auditing, Compliance (HIPAA), Vulnerability management.
- **Scripting and Automation:** T-SQL, PowerShell, Python, PL/SQL, CI/CD pipelines, Git, GitHub, Agile/Scrum, Automation scripts for administration, monitoring & ETL processes.
- **Monitoring & Administration Tools:** SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS), Extended Events, Activity Monitor, Performance Monitor, DBCC, HPDM, Squirrel, DBVisualizer, DIAL (HP internal tool).

- **ETL, BI & Reporting:** SSIS, SSRS, SSAS, Azure Data Factory (ADF), Power BI, Tableau, Power Automate, Erwin, Contentful, Data Warehousing, ETL pipeline design & troubleshooting.
- **Cloud & Virtualization:** Microsoft Azure (ADF, Azure Monitor, Azure Backup, Managed Instance, RBAC), AWS (RDS, EC2, S3, Lambda, Storage Gateway), VMware, Hyper-V.
- **Development & Integration:** .NET, Java, JavaScript, C#, React, Vue; Application integration with SQL Server and cloud-based data services.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & TRAININGS

- Master in Computer Science – University of Lyon
- B.S., Electrical Engineering – Bahir Dar University
- Certifications: Ultimate AWS certified solutions architect associate, Python, Java
- Training: Tableau Desktop and Server Administration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BAO System

July 2022 - Present

Senior SQL Server DBA, Washington, DC

- Installation, Upgrade, Configuration and Migration of SQL Server in clustered and non-clustered production environments.
- Setting up the Transactional Replication in between SQL Server databases.
- Administered SQL Server clusters (2016–2022) across critical healthcare systems; ensured 99.99% uptime and responsive failover support.
- Administered Azure SQL Database and Managed Instances, supporting hybrid environments and optimizing performance for healthcare clients.
- Implemented database encryption, auditing, and HIPAA-aligned security controls to safeguard sensitive data.
- Automated backup verification, health checks, and compliance reports using PowerShell and Python scripting, reducing manual workload by 70%.
- Collaborated with developers and BI teams to design and troubleshoot ETL pipelines (SSIS, Azure Data Factory) for reliable data integration. Planning for backup and recovery of database information.
- Led performance tuning efforts using SQL Profiler, Query Store, and indexing strategies, reducing query latency by over 40%.
- Created reports in SQL server using SSRS as per the requirements provided by the Front-End users.
- Assisted developers by troubleshooting network and instance-specific SQL Server connectivity errors.
- Worked on Integration services for the purpose of transforming data from the cubes and storing it into the data into the SQL Server tables.

- Involved in SQL Server Reporting Services (2019 SSRS) maintenance.
- Expertise in Performance monitoring & Tuning, Query Optimization, Client/Server Connectivity and Database Consistency Checks using DBCC Utilities.
- Responsible for data migration from Excel, Flat file, Sybase, Oracle to Microsoft SQL Server by using BCP and DTS utilities as well as Extracting, Transforming and Loading of data using Microsoft SQL Server SSIS and DTS.
- Managed data migration projects from SQL Server 2016 to 2019/2022 with planned downtime.
- Worked with Change Data Capture (CDC) feature in SQL server to capture all the changes during migration of data between databases.
- Proactively created and executed PowerShell scripts for backup verification, patch compliance, and health monitoring
- Developed and documented backups, recovery strategies, disaster recovery mechanism and participated in disaster recovery drills for various environments.
- Successfully implemented Log shipping for DR solutions.
- Proactively managed Microsoft SQL Server instances by developing Microsoft SQL scripts for creation and upgrade of databases, maintenance plans, user logins, automation of network and server monitoring.
- Extensively worked on upgrading Microsoft SQL server, failover clustering, log shipping, and replication.
- Using System Monitor and SQL Server Profiler to identify bottlenecks, discovering slow-running queries, performing backup and recovery databases, and implementing database modifications on production servers.
- Involved in development of databases including creating new databases, converting old databases to new databases, modification of existing databases, creating reports to meet business needs.
- Hand on experience in troubleshooting all database related issues.

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May 2020 – June 2022

SQL Server Database Administrator, New York

- Supported critical SQL Server environments in a global production landscape.
- Installed and configured two node clustering i.e. active/active and active/passive
- Extract data from external systems, transform data and load them into the existing databases using SSIS packages
- Experience in Data Modeling (Logical and Physical Design of Databases), Normalization and building Referential Integrity Constraints.
- Designed schemas. Built tables, FKs, PKs, etc. by providing a structure that meets the business needs.
- supported cloud migration planning and proof-of-concept deployments involving Azure SQL Database, ensuring secure and scalable design.

- Implement backup plans, monitor and maintain Backup and Recovery on servers.
- Perform daily, weekly and monthly Database Maintenance tasks.
- Database design and optimization of databases for better performance.
- Managing SQL Server security by creating roles and security groups.
- Monitor and resolve blocking issues in coordination with the application team.
- Proactively check the SQL error log and take appropriate action to avoid downtime.
- Analyze slow running queries across environments and find the root cause for the same and resolve by introducing missing indexes, partitioning tables and placing them in different file groups on different drives to improve performance.
- Configuring and maintaining Disaster recovery techniques such as mirroring, log shipping and clusters.
- Monitoring SQL Server performance by finding deadlocks and blocking.
- Import/Export data as per user request using import export wizard.
- Deploying/Migrating DTS and SSIS packages - help troubleshoot issues with packages.
- Perform database refresh and fix orphaned users on the refreshed database.
- Support Disaster recovery project planning, testing and implementation.
- Worked on Migrating data from SQL server 2016 to 2019.
- Provided secondary DBA support for Oracle databases.
- Provided on-call support for critical database operations during and outside of business hours, ensuring continuous service availability.

Amref Health

Feb 2018 - April 2020

Associate Database Administrator

- Monitored SQL Server performance metrics including CPU, memory, I/O, and disk space to ensure optimal server health and capacity planning.
- Deployed and configured production SQL Server environments, including clustered instances and reporting services to support high availability and scalability.
- Developed and maintained SSIS packages for extracting, transforming, and loading (ETL) data from OLTP and OLAP systems, scheduling jobs to automate package execution and stored procedure calls.
- Supported internal and external stakeholders with data extraction and ETL processes using SQL Server Integration Services (SSIS), DTS, Bulk Insert, and BCP utilities.
- Conducted regular audits to maintain compliance with HIPAA security standards using tools such as Idera Compliance Manager and Microsoft Mapping Toolkit.
- Executed weekly database backups and refreshes to support testing, training, and development environments.

- Maintained high availability of database servers in line with organizational SLA requirements, implementing failover and disaster recovery strategies.
- Designed and managed database objects including tables, views, clustered and non-clustered indexes, stored procedures, and triggers, while ensuring referential integrity and data consistency.
- Configured transactional and snapshot replication across SQL Server 2008, and 2012 instances to support data synchronization and distribution.
- Documented standard operating procedures and routine maintenance tasks (e.g., daily health checks, database integrity verification, security updates) to uphold system lifecycle best practices.
- Managed user roles and permissions within Dynamics CRM, ensuring appropriate access control and security compliance.
- Administered Tableau projects, sites, users, and role assignments to maintain secure and organized BI environments.
- Designed and maintained backend services using .NET Core and Java Spring Boot with SQL Server and PostgreSQL.
- Built internal web dashboards and admin tools using React and Vue.js, Developed RESTful APIs and integrating APIs with SQL and Python services.
- Created Python scripts for automation, data validation, and report generation.
- Participated in Agile sprints, contributing to DevOps automation, CI/CD pipelines, and code reviews.